COMIC CRAFT MASTER GUIDE

Essential Rules for Comic Lettering, Typography & Speech Balloons

1. DIALOGUE LETTERING RULES

- **Cross-bar 'I':** Use the letter 'I' with top and bottom serifs ONLY for the personal pronoun ("I am", "I'll", "I think"). For all other words (e.g., INSIDE, CAT), use a straight line stem 'I'.
- **Text Alignment:** Always center-align text inside speech balloons. Ensure paragraph blocks form a clean oval/diamond shape to fit naturally inside bubbles.
- **Bold Emphasis:** Use bold weights sparingly to emphasize key verbs or emotional cues rather than nouns.

2. STANDARD FONT HIERARCHY

Element Type	Recommended Style	Usage & Context
Dialogue	Regular / Clean Script	Standard speech in balloons (10pt - 12pt).
Sound Effects (SFX)	Bold / Distorted Display	Action impacts, explosions, environmental sounds.
Caption Boxes	Square Sans-Serif / All Caps	Narration, timestamps, or location indicators.
Whispers / Thoughts	Light / Italicized / Smaller	Dashed balloons or subtle internal monologue.

3. SPEECH BALLOON TAIL PLACEMENT

- Point tails directly toward the speaker's mouth, but do not touch the character.
- Keep tail curves smooth and natural. Avoid awkward S-curves or sharp kinks.
- Ensure order of reading moves strictly top-left to bottom-right across the page.

Pro Tip: Never place a balloon tail crossing over another character's face or key action elements!